



“Open source tools help you to leverage on other people’s expertise”

Mike Pyle,
senior vice president,
Engineering, Pegasystems Inc.

Looking for an engineering job? Open source technology can make your journey easier, says **Mike Pyle, senior vice president, Engineering, Pegasystems Inc.** **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** caught up with Mike during Pegasystems’ developers’ conference for a detailed discussion on how developers can find a job in this firm. Excerpts:

Q How does Pegasystems use open source technology?
We like the concept of open source technology, and we use a lot of open source to make our products. We don’t produce open source technology. So we don’t make products and put them in the public domain, but we do use a lot of open source technology and are a part of quite a few projects as well. We have recently acquired Antenna, which contributed to a European Union initiative to create open source components for the mobile world. So, in a nutshell, we do use a lot of open source elements in our product.

Q What kind of development processes do you have at Pega India?

We have the same development processes being followed in various Pega branches worldwide and India is no exception. We use AJA and SCRUM in particular. Some elements of AJA are tested and designed with respect to programming, but we adopted SCRUM as the primary

vehicle for moving forward the development processes at Pega. We did this adoption of technology four-five years ago. Before that, I think we did not have much development of technology. When I joined Pega, the company had around 20 people and our engineering organisation had about 10 people. Our development methodology depended immensely on the traditional process of bringing people into the room, doing things on the white board, and then people returning to their desks to write the code. It was a very small development team.

If you look at the growth of Pega, it was very slow for at least the first 15 years. Most of our accelerated growth has happened in the past 10-12 years. We deliberately tried to shift from being an applications company to being a platform company. Our investments in R&D have been accelerating. As we grow bigger and as we grow more distributed around the world, we decided that we needed a methodology to give us some discipline.

While evaluating the development technologies at